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RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN STUDENTS' ENGAGEMENT IN RELIGIOUS ACTIVITIES AND ACADEMIC ACHIEVEMENT IN ESAN WEST LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA OF EDO STATE, NIGERIA BY

Mercy OKOSUN, Ph.D.

Department of Educational Foundations and Management
Faculty of Education, Ambrose Alli University, Ekpoma, Edo State
<https://orcid.org/000-0002-5936-5106> okounm96@gmail.com.

S. A. ASEMHE

Department of Educational Management, Faculty of Education
Adekunle Ajasin University, Akungba-Akoko, Ondo State
<https://orcid.org/0000-0002-3784-5678> asemhesanni@gmail.com.

Andrew E. OJIEMHENKELE, Ph.D.

Department of Educational Foundations and Management
Faculty of Education, Ambrose Alli University, Ekpoma, Edo State
<https://orcid.org/0009-0004-8917-859X>
andrewojies@gmail.com.

Abstract

This study investigated the relationship between secondary school students' engagement in religious activities and their learning outcome in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State, Nigeria. Three research questions and three hypotheses guided the study which adopted the correlational research design. An instrument titled; Students Engagement in Religious Activities and Learning Outcome Questionnaire (SERALOQ)" was used to gather necessary data from a sample of 364 drawn from a population of 7,279 students in all the public secondary schools in the local government area. The result however revealed that positive relationship exists between students' engagement in fasting

and devotional services and students' learning outcome, as well as private/group prayers and students learning outcome among others. Based on the findings of this study, it was however recommended that, religious bodies should be encouraged to collaborate with secondary schools to support students' academic and personal development as this can involve creating joint programs that reinforce the values of discipline, diligence, and respect for authority, which are shown to positively impact learning, among others.

Keywords: Students engagement, Religious Activities, Learning Outcome.

Introduction

Education is the most potent instrument for individual and societal transformation. It is the cornerstone for economic growth, social advancement, and human empowerment. At the core of education lies the pursuit of **learning outcomes** that transcend cognitive development to include emotional, moral, and spiritual growth (UNESCO, 2021). The **National Policy on Education** articulates the vision of developing the total individual through the inculcation of sound moral, spiritual, and civic values alongside intellectual training (Federal Republic of Nigeria FRN, 2013). Secondary education, which bridges basic and tertiary levels, is particularly crucial as it prepares learners for higher education and responsible citizenship. However, in achieving these objectives, Nigerian schools operate within a multi-religious environment where students' faith-based engagements such as fasting, devotional practices, attendance at religious services, and group prayers often intersect with academic activities. This intersection raises pertinent questions about the extent to which religious practices influence learning outcomes.

Students' engagement in **fasting and devotional practices** represents a vital dimension of religious life that can have both spiritual and educational implications. Fasting seasons such as Ramadan and Lent encourage self-discipline, focus, and reflection, but they may also cause physical exhaustion, dehydration, and reduced classroom attentiveness. Eze and Okonkwo (2022) observed that some students exhibit reduced academic performances during fasting periods, others demonstrate improved emotional control and spiritual resilience. These mixed findings suggest that the relationship between fasting, devotional commitment, and academic achievement is complex and context-dependent. The relationship between students' engagement in religious activities and learning outcomes represents a vital intersection of theology, education, and adolescent development. As schools increasingly emphasize holistic education, understanding how religious participation influences academic performance becomes critical. Brook et al., (2011); Ibok et al., (2020).

Findings from projects such as the Effective Pre-school and Primary Education (EPPE 3–11) highlight that positive peer relationships and self-perceptions nurtured in religious settings can improve academic performance and pro-social behavior (Sylva, et al., 2008). Similarly, community-oriented aspects of religious engagement such as volunteering and group prayers are associated with improved learning experiences and higher academic achievement (Craton, 2016). These benefits extend beyond spiritual growth to encompass social competence, moral awareness, and emotional stability (Hackett et al., 2015).

Abukanna, et al (2023) investigated the effects of fasting on student performance in exams at Northern Border University, Saudi Arabia. A cross-sectional study conducted among 445 college students in Saudi Arabia examined the effects of fasting during Ramadan on academic performance. Fasting was found to negatively influence students' academic performance by causing fatigue, headaches, and decreased attentiveness.

Another common expression of students' religiosity is **attendance at religious services**, which includes participation in school fellowships, weekend services, and mid-week worship programs. Such activities are often associated with positive moral formation and communal belonging. Yet, excessive attendance especially when it conflicts with study hours or school schedules may interfere with academic engagement.

Students' attendance at religious services may have significant influences their moral and intellectual development. Such gatherings provide structured environments that promote ethical conduct, responsibility, and wisdom values that support academic engagement (Hill & Dik, 2020). Through regular participation, students develop discipline, punctuality, and time management skills, which can positively translate into effective study habits and academic consistency (King & Boyatzis, 2015). However, excessive participation in religious activities may encroach on study time, underscoring the need for balance. When properly managed, attendance at religious services complements academic pursuits by reinforcing discipline, emotional well-being, and moral purpose, ultimately contributing to holistic learning outcomes (Miller, 2021).

Loury (2004) examined how church attendance really increase schooling? Any estimated correlation between church attendance and schooling without such controls may reflect unmeasured family, community, and individual characteristics. The size of the effect for individuals who attended church 52 weeks per year compared to individuals who do not attend at all is equivalent to over three years of parents' schooling. This finding implies that changes in church attendance, either due to exogenous changes in attitudes or as an indirect effect of government or other institutional activity, may have large spill-over effects on socioeconomic variables. Uzoagba, Ebebe & Keke (2024) carried out a study on the regular social and religious activities and its effects on academic performance of social studies students in school of arts and social sciences, Alvan-Ikoku Federal College of Education, Owerri. Findings revealed among others that regular attendance to night vigil affects the academic performance of students also that regular attendance to night clubs affects the academic performance of students in higher institutions.

Students' participation in private and group prayers can significantly influence their learning outcomes by shaping their cognitive, emotional, and moral orientations toward education. Whether performed individually or collectively, prayer provides a reflective and purposeful space that fosters focus and intentionality. Students who engage in regular prayer often experience inner peace and mental clarity, enhancing their concentration and overall academic performance. Taking time to pray can also reduce anxiety, organize priorities, and renew motivation—all of which are essential for effective learning (Miller, 2021). Private prayer, in particular, nurtures self-discipline and emotional regulation, provide comfort and renewed determination to persist in studies (Tan & Yarhouse, 2022).

Fabula (2024) carried out a study on the perceived impact of prayer on college students' academic performance. This descriptive correlational study aimed to determine the effects of prayer on academic performance as perceived by college students of De La Salle-College of Saint Benilde in a BIBCHUR (Bible and Church) course. Results showed that students' perception of prayer is 3.40, or prayer moderately affects academic performance. This result indicates a negligible correlation between prayer and academic performance.

Armando (2019) examined student engagement and academic performance of students of Partido State University. The study revealed that the level of student engagement along behavioral, emotional and cognitive engagements were high with a mean of 2.84. It was found out that academic performance of the respondents was very good (GWA=1.83). The correlational analysis found that teacher ($r=.125$, $p=.029$), school ($r=.143$, $p=.013$), and family factors ($r=.106$, $p=.028$) were positively related to student engagement, while the Multiple Linear Regression analysis revealed that there was relatively low percentage of variance (1.8%) but shows that the factors were significant predictors of student engagement $F(3, 301)=2.905$. Furthermore, it was found out that behavioral, emotional and cognitive engagements were positively correlated to the academic performance of the students.

Othoo and Omondi (2022) carried out a study on the impact of students' involvement in co-curricular activities on academic performance in Gem Sub County, Siaya County, Kenya. The study found out that participation in co-curricular activities positively influences students' academic performance.

Statement of the Problem

In recent years, there has been a noticeable increase in students' active participation in diverse religious activities within and outside secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State. These activities such as fasting and devotional practices, regular attendance at religious services, and involvement in private or group prayers are often encouraged by parents, teachers, and religious leaders for their perceived moral and spiritual benefits. However, growing concerns have emerged among educators and school administrators regarding the possible implications of these practices, whether positive or negative, on students' academic performance and overall learning outcomes. A particular concern relates to students' engagement in **fasting and devotional practices**, especially during academic sessions. Many students observe prolonged fasts as part of their religious commitments, which can lead to fatigue, reduced concentration, and lower classroom participation. Some also devote substantial time to early morning or evening devotional activities, sometimes at the expense of study time or adequate rest. Although these practices foster spiritual growth and discipline, their influence on students' cognitive functioning and learning efficiency remains unclear within the Esan West context.

Similarly, **frequent attendance at religious services** has become a common feature among secondary school students in the area. While participation in worship services may strengthen moral character and social belonging, it has been observed that some students attend multiple services during the school week, occasionally during study hours. Teachers have reported cases of lateness to school,

absenteeism, or missed assignments linked to early morning or mid-week services. These patterns suggest a possible conflict between religious devotion and academic responsibility. Furthermore, students' **involvement in private or group prayers** also raises questions about balance and priority. For some, consistent prayer enhances emotional stability, confidence, and mental readiness for learning. For others, excessive prayer activities especially when they coincide with study periods may reduce academic focus or preparation time.

Despite these observable realities, empirical research addressing how students' fasting and devotional practices, attendance at religious services, and involvement in private or group prayers relate to their learning outcomes in Esan West Local Government Area is limited. This gap necessitates a systematic investigation into the extent and nature of these relationships, with a view to determining whether religious engagements among students serve as facilitators or inhibitors of academic success. In light of these perspectives, it becomes necessary to empirically examine how students' engagement in fasting and devotional practices, attendance at religious services, and involvement in private or group prayers relate to their learning outcomes. Understanding these relationships is essential in achieving a balance between **religious devotion** and **academic performance** within the secondary school context in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State.

Purpose of the Study

This study investigated the relationship between students' engagement in religious activities and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State. The specific objectives of the study are to:

1. examine the relationship between students' engagement in fasting and devotional practices and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State
2. investigate the relationship between students' **attendance at religious services** and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State
3. ascertain the relationship between students' involvement in group prayers and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State

Research Questions

The following research questions were raised to guide the study:

- 1 To what extent do students' engagement in fasting and devotional practices influence learning outcomes in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State?
- 2 To what extent does students' attendance at religious services influence learning outcomes in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State?
- 3 To what extent does students' involvement in private/group prayers influence learning outcomes in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State?

Hypotheses

The study was guided by following hypotheses.

1. There is no significant relationship between students' engagement in fasting and devotional practices and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State
2. There is no significant relationship between students' **attendance at religious services** and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State
3. There is no significant relationship between students' involvement in private/group prayers and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State.

Methodology

The study adopted the correlational research design. The population of the study was made up of all the seven thousand, two hundred and seventy-nine (7,279) students in all the 16 public secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State, Nigeria. A sample size of 364 respondents representing 5 percent of the total population was drawn using the simple random sampling technique.

An instrument titled "Students Engagement in Religious Activities and Learning Outcome Questionnaire (SERALOOQ)" was used to elicit responses from the respondents. The instrument was divided into two sections; A & B. Section A, contained item on students' engagement in religious activities and it was made up of three subsections that contained five items each that were responded to by the students. Each of the items had four response scales (Very Frequent 4 points, Frequent 3 points, Less Frequent 2 points, Not Frequent 1 point). While Section B contained fifteen items on students learning outcomes, which were responded to by teachers. These items had four response scales (Very Good 4 points, Good 3 points, Poor 2 points, Very Poor 1 point).

The instrument was content validated and later subjected to a test-retest to establish its reliability, which was done by administering 20 copies of the instrument to respondents in Esan Central Local Government Area of Edo State which was outside the study area. After two weeks, the same instrument was administered to the same respondents and the two sets of scores were correlated using the Pearson Product Moment Correlation Coefficient, with a correlation coefficient of .61 and .79 for students' engagement in religious activities and students' learning outcome respectively. The data collected for the study were analyzed using the Pearson Product Moment Correlations Coefficient, while the hypotheses raised for the study were tested at a significant level of 0.05.

Presentation of Results

Research Question One: To what extent do students' engagement in fasting and devotional practices influence learning outcomes in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State?

Table 1: Descriptive analysis of the extent students' engagement in fasting and devotional practices influence learning outcomes in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State

S/N	Items	($\bar{X}$)	SD	Decision
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1	My engagement in fasting and devotional practices improves my concentration during classroom lessons.	3.31	0.76	High
2	Regular fasting and devotional activities encourage me to study more effectively	3.18	0.81	High
3	Fasting and devotional practices help me complete my academic assignments on time	3.07	0.85	High
4	My participation in fasting and devotional practices contributes to better academic performance in school	3.25	0.79	High
5	Fasting and devotional practices motivate me to remain committed to my learning activities	3.39	0.74	High
Grand Mean		3.24	0.79	High

The results in Table 1 shows the descriptive analysis of the extent students' engagement in fasting and devotional practices influence learning outcomes in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State. The results shows that students perceived that engagement in fasting and devotional practices influences their learning outcomes to a **high extent**, with a **grand mean of 3.24 (SD = 0.79)**, which is above the criterion mean of 2.50. Specifically, students agreed that fasting and devotional practices motivate them to remain committed to their learning activities ($\bar{X}$ =3.39, SD=0.74), improve their concentration during classroom lessons ($\bar{X}$ =3.31, SD=0.76), contribute to better academic performance ($\bar{X}$ =3.25, SD=0.79), encourage them to study more effectively ($\bar{X}$ =3.18, SD=0.81), and help them complete academic assignments on time ($\bar{X}$ =3.07, SD=0.85). This shows that students perceive fasting and devotional practices as having a substantial positive influence on their learning outcomes in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State.

Research Question Two: To what extent does students' attendance at religious services influence learning outcomes in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State?

Table 2: Descriptive analysis of the extent students' engagement in fasting and devotional practices influence learning outcomes in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State

S/N	Items	($\bar{X}$)	SD	Decision
1	My regular attendance at religious services motivates me to perform well academically.	3.28	0.77	High
2	Attending religious services helps me maintain discipline that improves my learning.	3.34	0.73	High
3	Teachings received during religious services encourage me to participate actively in classroom activities.	3.19	0.82	High
4	My attendance at religious services inspires me to devote more time to my studies.	3.14	0.84	High

5	Regular attendance at religious services contributes to my overall learning achievement.	3.30	0.76	High
Grand Mean		3.25	0.78	High

The results presented in Table 2 indicates that students perceived that attendance at religious services influences their learning outcomes to a **high extent**, with a **grand mean of 3.25 (SD=0.78)**, which is above the criterion mean of 2.50. The highest-rated item was "attending religious services helps me maintain discipline that improves my learning" ($\bar{X}$ =3.34, SD=0.73), followed by "regular attendance at religious services contributes to my overall learning achievement" ($\bar{X}$ =3.30, SD=0.76) and "my regular attendance at religious services motivates me to perform well academically" ($\bar{X}$ =3.28, SD=0.77). Furthermore, students agreed that teachings received during religious services encourage active participation in classroom activities ($\bar{X}$ =3.19, SD=0.82) and inspire them to devote more time to their studies ($\bar{X}$ =3.14, SD=0.84). This reveals that regular attendance at religious services positively influences students' learning outcomes in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State.

Research Question Three: To what extent does students' involvement in private/group prayers influence learning outcomes in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State?

Table 3: Descriptive analysis of the extent students' engagement in fasting and devotional practices influence learning outcomes in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State

S/N	Items	X	SD	Decision
1	My participation in private or group prayers improves my confidence in learning.	3.36	0.72	High
2	Private and group prayers help me remain focused during academic activities.	3.29	0.77	High
3	Praying regularly motivates me to overcome challenges in my studies.	3.41	0.69	High
4	My involvement in private or group prayers enhances my academics.	3.22	0.81	High
5	Participation in private and group prayers encourages me to develop positive study habits.	3.33	0.75	High
Grand Mean		3.32	0.75	High

The results presented in Table 3 reveal that students perceived that involvement in private and group prayers influences their learning outcomes to a **high extent**, with a **grand mean of 3.32 (SD = 0.75)**, which is above the criterion mean of 2.50. The highest-rated item was "praying regularly motivates me to overcome challenges in my studies" ($\bar{X}$ = 3.41, SD = 0.69), followed by "my participation in private or group prayers improves my confidence in learning" ($\bar{X}$ = 3.36, SD = 0.72) and "participation in private and group prayers encourages me to develop positive study habits" ($\bar{X}$ = 3.33, SD = 0.75). Students also agreed that private and group prayers help them remain focused during

academic activities ($\bar{X} = 3.29$, $SD = 0.77$) and that involvement in private or group prayers enhances their academics ($\bar{X} = 3.22$, $SD = 0.81$). This implies that, to a high extent, students' involvement in private and group prayers contributes to their learning outcomes in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State.

Test of Hypotheses

Hypothesis 1: There is no significant relationship between students' engagement in fasting and devotional practices and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State

Table 4: Summary analysis of the relationship between students' engagement in fasting and devotional practices and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State

Variables	N	Pearson(r)	Sig. value	Remark
Students' Engagement in Fasting/Devotional Practices	364	.522	.015	Significant (p<05) Ho rejected
Students' Learning Outcome				

Correlation is significant at the 0.05 level (2-tailed).

Table 4 presents the summary of Pearson r analysis of the relationship between students' engagement in fasting and devotional practices and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State. The calculated value of r of .522 was significant at .05 level of significance ($P < .05$). The null hypothesis was therefore rejected. This meant that there is a significant relationship between students' engagement in fasting and devotional practices and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State.

Hypothesis 5: There is no significant relationship between students' attendance at religious services and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State

Table 5: Summary analysis of the relationship between students' attendance at religious services and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State

Variables	N	Pearson(r)	Sig. value	Remark
Students' Attendance at Religious Services	364	.613	.001	Significant (p<05) Ho rejected
Students' Learning Outcome				

Correlation is significant at the 0.05 level (2-tailed).

Table 5 presents the summary of Pearson r analysis of the relationship between students' attendance at religious services and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local

Government Area of Edo State. The r coefficient value of .613 was significant at .05 level of significance ($P < .05$). Hence, the null hypothesis was rejected. This indicated that there is a significant relationship between students' **attendance at religious services** and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State.

Hypothesis Three: There is no significant relationship between students' involvement in private/group prayers and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State

Table 6: Summary analysis of the relationship between students' involvement in private/group prayers and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State

Variables	N	Pearson(r)	Sig. value	Remark
Students' Involvement in Private/Group Prayers	364	.720	.003	Significant ($p < .05$) Ho rejected
Students' Learning Outcome				

Correlation is significant at the 0.05 level (2-tailed).

Table 6 presents the r analysis of the relationship between students' involvement in private/group prayers and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State. The analysis showed a significant relationship at .05 level of significance because the calculated value of .680 was significant ($P < 0.05$). The null hypothesis was therefore rejected. It showed that significant relationship exist between students' involvement in private/group prayers and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State.

Discussion

The results of the study showed that there is a positive significant relationship between students' engagement in fasting and devotional practices and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State. This relationship can be justified by the psychological and cognitive benefits often associated with these practices. Fasting could enhance self-discipline, focus, and mental clarity, which are crucial for effective learning. Similarly, devotional practices like prayer and meditation can reduce stress, improve emotional regulation, and create a sense of calm, all of which contribute to a more conducive learning environment. These practices could foster a disciplined mindset and a positive mental state, which directly and positively impacts students' ability to concentrate, retain information and perform well academically.

The finding of the study is in agreement with that of Brooks, et al (2011); Ibok et al (2020) which found that fasting impacts on students' exam preparation at university level. The study conducted by Abukanna, et al (2023) that fasting negatively impacts on students' academic performance in exams at Northern Border University, Saudi Arabia and that of Arni, et al (2024)

which concluded that fasting significant negative impact on student's academic performance however contradicted this study. Also, this finding does not equally support that of Almutairi, et al (2023) that studying during Ramadan fasting hours negatively affects academic performance of students as well as their sleep quality.

The results of the study showed that there is a significant relationship between students' **attendance at religious services** and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State. There could be a justifiable connection between students' attendance at religious services and their academic outcomes and this is because participation in religious services could provide students with a structured environment that promotes discipline, social support, and a sense of community. Many religious institutions emphasize values such as diligence, respect, and responsibility, which are contingent to a positive learning attitude. Also, the communal aspect of religious gatherings could create a strong social network, offering students access to mentors, peers, and adults who can provide guidance and encouragement, thus fostering an atmosphere of mutual support that can positively influence their academic pursuits.

The finding of the study is in line with that of Kitjaroonchai & Hungyo (2017), in which they concluded that students' participation in moral and religious activities have positive correlation with their academic achievement Thailand. However, the study of Uzoagba, et al (2024) concluded that religious activities had negative significant effects on academic performance of social studies students in school of arts and social sciences, Alvan- Ikoku Federal College of Education, Owerri. The finding of this study equally contradicted that of Ali et al (2019) that religious practices negatively impacted on academic achievements of students at secondary level. This finding also disagrees with that of Some Jesus Christ of Latter day Saints College Students from Brigham Young University (2000), which concluded that there exists a negative relationship between religion activities and academic performance,

The results of the study showed that a significant relationship exist between students' involvement in private/group prayers and learning outcome in secondary schools in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State. This connection can be explained by the psychological, social, and cognitive benefits of prayer. Private prayer often serves as a form of mindfulness and self-reflection, helping students to clear their minds, reduce anxiety, and focus on their academic goals. This can lead to improved concentration and mental clarity. Group prayers, on the other hand, build a strong sense of community and social support among peers. This shared practice fosters a positive and encouraging environment where students can support each other, share their struggles, and feel a sense of belonging. The moral and ethical guidance often associated with these prayers can also promote self-discipline and a diligent work ethic, which are critical for academic success.

The finding of the study is in agreement with the findings of Kopic (2022) that students' involvement in private and group prayers can positively impact learning outcomes by promoting mental clarity, emotional stability, moral integrity, and a sense of community. The finding is in conformity with that of Kamal, et al (2022) that student religious groups who broadcasted and socialized congregational prayers can provide students with a true religious understanding and could prevent radicalism with a narrow religious understanding. This finding does not corroborate that of

Fabula (2024) whose result indicated that prayer and academic performance had no significant correlation, though the finding completely agrees with that of Armando (2019) that behavioral, emotional and cognitive engagements which are contingent to religious worship were positively correlated to the academic performance of the students of Partido State University.

Conclusion

Based on the findings of this study, it could be concluded that a positive and significant relationship exists between various forms of religious engagement and the academic performance of secondary school students in Esan West Local Government Area of Edo State, Nigeria. The study demonstrates that students who participate in fasting, devotional practices, religious services, private/group prayers, and mentorship within religious settings tend to achieve better learning outcomes. This is likely due to the fact that these activities promote discipline, mental well-being, social support, and a sense of community, all of which are contingent to effective learning. The findings however suggest that religious involvement is not a hindrance but rather a valuable factor that can contribute to students' holistic development and academic success.

Recommendations

Based on these findings, the following recommendations were made:

1. Religious bodies should be encouraged to collaborate with secondary schools to support students' academic and personal development as this can involve creating joint programs that reinforce the values of discipline, diligence, and respect for authority, which are shown to positively impact learning.
2. Schools should actively promote and integrate mentoring programs, particularly those linked with religious institutions. These programs can provide students with structured guidance, emotional support, and life skills that complement their academic learning and foster a positive attitude toward education.
3. Schools should be mindful of students' religious practices, such as fasting and prayer, and provide a supportive environment. This doesn't mean imposing these practices but rather accommodating them respectfully, as they contribute to a student's mental well-being and concentration, which are essential for academic success.

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